

Do Won Kim

dowonkim@umd.edu

do-won.github.io

Research Interests

I am a computational social scientist studying how digital information environments shape political beliefs and behavior—and how they can be designed to support informed decision-making and strengthen democracy.

Education

- 2023–Present **PhD in Information**, University of Maryland
Committee: **Giovanni Luca Ciampaglia** (Chair), **Cody Buntain** (Co-chair), Ernesto Calvo, Yiwei Xu, Ceren Budak
Dissertation: *Leveraging AI-Mediated Information Environment for Democracy*
- 2018 **MSc in European Studies (Research)**, London School of Economics
Dissertation: *Dimensionality, Party Competition and Voter Preference in the Era of Populism: The Case of England 2010–2017*
- 2017 **Bachelor of Business Administration;**
Bachelor of Science in Engineering (2nd degree conferred through the SKKU Institute for Convergence), Sungkyunkwan University

Research Affiliations

- 2023–Present **Computational Sociodynamics Lab, University of Maryland**
2026–27 Graduate Assistant, MPower Early Scholars Investment Fund [F1]
2025–26 Graduate Assistant, Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program (Supervisor: Eun Kyoung Choe) [F4]
2023–25 Research Assistant. Project: *Muting low-quality sources: A field experiment to mitigate the harm of inaccurate health information online* (Social Science Research Council). PIs: Giovanni Luca Ciampaglia (UMD), Brendan Nyhan (Dartmouth), Ro'ee Levy (TelAviv University), Maria Elizabeth Grabe (BU), and Filippo Menczer (IU)
- 2024–Present **Institute for Trustworthy AI in Law & Society (TRAILS)**
2026 Principal Investigator, TRAILS Mini-Grant [G1]
- 2020–23 **Center for Political Communication, Seoul National University**
2020–22 Research Assistant. Project: *Korean Voter in the Age of Deepfake: Measuring the Impact of Fake News with Big Data and Experiments* (National Research Foundation of Korea). PIs: Won-ho Park (SNU), Woo Chang Kang (Korea University), Shang E. Ha and BK Song (Sogang University)

Publications

 Google Scholar

† → Equal contribution

Working Papers

- W1. **Kim, Do Won**, Nyhan, B., Levy, R., Menczer, F., Grabe, M. E. & Ciampaglia, G. L. *Muting Durably Reduces Engagement with Untrustworthy Online Sources; Media Literacy Doesn't. Job Market Paper*. Manuscript in preparation. 2026.
- W2. **Kim, Do Won**, Seckin, O. C., Bhadani, S., Flammini, A., Ciampaglia, G. L. & Truong, B. T. *Challenging Partisan Expectations Reduces Political Polarization*. Preprint. 2026. <https://arxiv.org/abs/2606.15901>.
- W3. **Kim, Do Won**, Kim, H. & Park, W.-h. *Two Spheres of Korean Politics: Knowledge Production and Dissemination across Linguistic Divides*. Under review. 2026.

Refereed Conference and Workshop Papers

- C1. **Kim, Do Won**, Buntain, C. & Ciampaglia, G. L. *Understanding the Gap Between Stated and Revealed Preferences in Social Media News Feeds in Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction (CSCW '26)* **10** (Association for Computing Machinery, 2026), CSCW181:1–30. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3817029>.
- C2. **Kim, Do Won** & Buntain, C. *Emotional Appeals in the 2020 #SaveTheChildren Campaign: A Multi-Platform Study of Online Engagement in QAnon Messaging in Companion Publication of the 17th ACM Web Science Conference 2025 (WebSci Companion '25)* (Association for Computing Machinery, New York, NY, USA, 2025), 1–10. <https://doi.org/10.1145/3720554.3733843>.

Journal Articles

- J1. Kim[†], H., **Kim[†], Do Won** & Yang, J. Understanding motivations and future needs for data deposits at Korea Social Science Data Archive. *IASSIST Quarterly* **48**, 1–10. <https://doi.org/10.29173/iq1110> (2024).
- J2. Kang, W. C., **Kim, Do Won** & Kang, J. Smile to Win: How do Candidates' Smiles Affect Election Results? *Korean Political Science Review* **56**, 59–82. <https://doi.org/10.18854/kpsr.2022.56.4.003> (2022). KCI (In Korean), Corresponding Author.
- J3. **Kim, Do Won**. Voting against in the 2017 French presidential election. *French Politics* **20**, 121–146. <https://doi.org/10.1057/s41253-021-00165-7> (2022).
- J4. **Kim, Do Won** & Kim, H. Strategic Allocation of Political Funds and Re-election of Incumbents in South Korea. *Journal of Korean Politics* **31**, 57–91. <http://dx.doi.org/10.35656/JKP.31.2.3> (2022). KCI (In Korean), First Author.

Funding & Awards

Grants

- G1. Mini-Grant, Institute for Trustworthy AI in Law & Society (\$6,250; Role: PI). 2026.
- G2. Humane Studies Fellowship, Institute for Humane Studies (\$3,000; Role: PI). 2026.
- G3. Doctoral Students Research Awards, University of Maryland (\$1,500; Role: PI). 2026.
- G4. Doctoral Students Research Awards, University of Maryland (\$1,500; Role: PI). 2024.

Fellowships & Scholarships

- F1. MPower Early Scholars Investment Fund, University of Maryland (\$ 38,332). 2026–27.
- F2. Dean's Fellowship, University of Maryland (\$2,500). 2026.
- F3. Graduate Student Summer Research Fellowship (\$5,000). 2026.
- F4. Graduate Assistantship, Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, University of Maryland (\$33,453). 2025–26.
- F5. Dean's Fellowship, University of Maryland (\$2,500). 2025.
- F6. College of Information Studies Alumni Chapter Scholarship, University of Maryland (\$1,000). 2024.
- F7. Dean's Fellowship, University of Maryland (\$5,000). 2023–24.
- F8. GSI Scholarship, Seoul National University (\$13,663). 2020–22.

Research Prizes

- A1. Finalist of the **Prosocial Ranking Challenge**, UC Berkeley Center for Human-Compatible AI (\$6,000; with Bao Tran Truong, Saumya Bhadani, and Ozgur Can Seckin). 2024.

Travel Awards

- TA1. Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland (\$600). 2025.
- TA2. Dr. Dana Rotman Doctoral Student Travel Award, University of Maryland (\$600). 2025.
- TA3. International Conference Student Support Award, University of Maryland (\$208). 2025.
- TA4. PolNet-PaCSS 2025 Graduate Student Fellowship (\$200). 2025.
- TA5. Jacob K. Goldhaber Travel Grant, University of Maryland (\$250). 2024.

Presentations

* Presenter

Invited Talks & Tutorials

- I1. **Kim, Do Won.** *Tutorial on Large Language Model (LLM) Applications for Political Science Research.* Graduate Methods Workshop, Department of Political Science & International Relations at Korea University. Jan. 2026.
- I2. **Kim*, Do Won,** Kim, H. & Park, W.-h. *Two Spheres of Korean Politics: Knowledge Production and Dissemination across Linguistic Divides.* Brown Bag Seminar, Computational Social Science Group at KAIST. July 2025. <https://knowdem.github.io/css-group/css-brown-bag.html>.

Refereed Conference Talks

- T1. Kim, H., **Kim, Do Won** & Park*, W.-h. *Discovery Bottleneck: Infrastructural Barriers to Local Scholarship.* Japanese Political Science Association (JPSA) General Assembly & Annual Conference (Osaka, Japan). Oct. 2026.
- T2. **Kim, Do Won,** Seckin, O. C., Bhadani, S., Flammini, A., Ciampaglia, G. L. & Truong*, B. T. *Challenging Partisan Expectations Reduces Political Polarization.* The Nordic Conference on Computational Social Science (CS2Nordics) (Copenhagen, Denmark). Sept. 2026.
- T3. **Kim*, Do Won,** Ciampaglia, G. L., Grabe, M. E., Levy, R., Menczer, F. & Nyhan, B. *Muting Durably Reduces Engagement with Untrustworthy Online Sources; Media Literacy Doesn't.* APSA Preconference in Political Communication (Boston, USA). Sept. 2026.
- T4. **Kim*, Do Won** & Shin, H. *Learning Politics with AI: Political Knowledge, Institutional Trust, and Attitudes Toward Interbranch Conflict.* American Political Science Association (APSA) Annual Meeting (Boston, USA). Sept. 2026.
- T5. **Kim*, Do Won,** Truong, B. T., Seckin, O. C. & Bhadani, S. *The Effects of Outgroup Agreement and Ingroup Dissent on Political Polarization.* PolNet-PaCSS (Boston, USA). Aug. 2025.
- T6. **Kim, Do Won,** Truong, B. T., Seckin*, O. C. & Bhadani, S. *The Effects of Outgroup Agreement and Ingroup Dissent on Political Polarization.* International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²) (Norrköping, Sweden). July 2025.
- T7. **Kim*, Do Won,** Kim, H. & Park, W.-h. *Two Spheres of Korean Politics: Knowledge Production and Dissemination across Linguistic Divides.* IPSA World Congress of Political Science (Seoul, South Korea). July 2025.
- T8. **Kim*, Do Won** & Buntain, C. *Emotional Appeals in the 2020 #SaveTheChildren Campaign: A Multi-Platform Study of Online Engagement in QAnon Messaging.* Global Election and Information Security Workshop (New Brunswick, NJ, USA), part of the 17th ACM Web Science Conference (WebSci '25). May 2025.
- T9. **Kim*, Do Won** & Ha, S. E. *Narcissistic Personality and Political Behavior of Korean Voters.* Annual Conference of Korean Political Science Association (Seoul, South Korea). Dec. 2022.
- T10. Kang*, W. C., **Kim, Do Won** & Kang, J. *Individual Conditional Effect of Sex-Typicality and Trait Assessment of Politicians.* Annual Conference of Korean Political Science Association (Seoul, South Korea). Dec. 2022.

- T11. Tae*, H. & **Kim, Do Won**. *The Effect of the Government's Response to COVID-19 on Voting Behavior in the 2020 South Korean Legislative Election*. European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) Virtual Joint Sessions. May 2021.
- T12. **Kim*, Do Won** & Kim, H. *Strategic allocation of political funds: How does spending money help reelection?* Fall Conference of Korean Association of Party Studies (Seoul, South Korea). Nov. 2021.

Refereed Posters

- P1. **Kim*, Do Won**, Buntain, C., Ciampaglia, G. L. & Lankes, R. *Can AI Strengthen Democracy? Improving Public Trust in Elections with a Civic Chatbot*. International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²) (Burlington, VT, USA). July 2026.
- P2. **Kim*, Do Won**, Seckin, O. C., Bhadani, S., Flammini, A., Ciampaglia, G. L. & Truong, B. T. *AI Can Reduce Political Polarization by Challenging Partisan Expectations*. AI and Social Research: Empathic AI, Metascience, and Methodology (University Park, PA, USA). June 2026.
- P3. **Kim*, Do Won** & Bhadani, S. *Testing Alternative Algorithms for Social Media News Feeds: Audience Diversity and Stated Preferences-Based Recommender Systems*. International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²) (Norrköping, Sweden). July 2025.
- P4. Seckin*, O. C., Truong, B. T., **Kim, Do Won** & Bhadani, S. *Predicting Constructive Conflict in Social Media Discussions*. International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²) (Norrköping, Sweden). July 2025.
- P5. **Kim*, Do Won**, Ciampaglia, G. L., Grabe, M. E., Levy, R., Menczer, F. & Nyhan, B. *Muting low-quality sources: A field experiment to mitigate the harm of inaccurate information online*. International Conference on Computational Social Science (IC²S²) (Philadelphia, PA, USA). July 2024.
- P6. Jeon*, S. & **Kim, Do Won**. *Emotion in Presidential TV Debate: Real-time Responses and Political Information Processing*. 39th Annual Meeting of the Society for Political Methodology (PolMeth XXXIX) (St. Louis, MO, USA). July 2022.

Non-refereed Posters

- N1. Lu*, M. H., Robinson, V., Yu, R., Romero-Fabian, L., Zhu, J., **Kim, Do Won**, Ciampaglia, G. L. & Buntain, C. *Evaluating Accuracy and Safety of Election Chatbot*. 43rd Annual Symposium of the Human-Computer Interaction Lab (HCIL), University of Maryland (College Park, MD, USA). May 2026.
- N2. Lu*, M. H., Robinson, V., Yu, R., Romero-Fabian, L., Zhu, J., **Kim, Do Won**, Ciampaglia, G. L. & Buntain, C. *Evaluating Accuracy and Safety of Election Chatbot*. Inaugural Research & Learning Symposium, Artificial Intelligence Interdisciplinary Institute at Maryland (AIM), University of Maryland (College Park, MD, USA). May 2026.

Software & Research Systems

- S1. **Agentic sockpuppet experiment framework:** LLM-driven sockpuppet agents for controlled platform-intervention experiments on X. Built with mentee William Bradshaw (see [Mentoring & Advising](#)). github.com/wjbradshawTerp/ScraperSky. 2026.
- S2. **VIOLETS:** retrieval-augmented civic chatbot grounded in official state and local election information. Built with mentees in the Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program (see [Mentoring & Advising](#)). github.com/CSDL-UMD/VIOLETS. 2026.
- S3. **Muting experiment on X:** data-collection and intervention pipeline for the SSRC-funded Mercury field experiment. github.com/CSDL-UMD/Mercury. 2023–26.
- S4. **Bridging news-feed ranking algorithm:** finalist submission to the [Prosocial Ranking Challenge](#), UC Berkeley Center for Human-Compatible AI. github.com/btrantruong/dante-prosocial-ranking (see [A1]). 2024.

Teaching & Mentoring

Teaching

2025	University of Maryland
2025	INST408G: Special Topics in Information Science (Instructor for Quantitative Methods Sessions); part of the Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program
2021–23	Korea Social Science Data Archive
2022–23	Intermediate Statistics (Lab session)
2021–23	Panel Data Analysis (Lab session)
2020–22	Seoul National University
2020–22	Scope and Methods of Political Science (TA)
2021	Human Rights (TA)
2021	Studies in Law and Politics: Discrimination and Inequality (TA)
2021	Principles of Political Science (TA)

Mentoring & Advising

2024–Present	Computational Sociodynamics Lab, University of Maryland
2026–Present	<i>William Bradshaw</i> , BSc in Computer Science; co-built the agentic sockpuppet experiment framework (see [S1])
2024–25	<i>Krishnan Tholkappian</i> , BSc in Computer Science
2026	Undergraduate Research Opportunities Program, University of Maryland
Spring 2026	<i>Ryan Yu</i> (BSc in Information Science and Applied Mathematics), <i>Megan Lu</i> , <i>Lina Romero-Fabian</i> , <i>Vashawn Robinson</i> , <i>Johnny Zhu</i> (BSc in Information Science); co-built the RAG election chatbot (see [S2])

Academic Service

Program Committee	International Workshop on Cyber Social Threats (at ICWSM) (×3)
Journal Reviewer	Nature; Behaviour & Information Technology
Conference Reviewer	CHI (×2); CSCW (×2); ICWSM (×2); International Conference on Computational Social Science, IC^2S^2 (×3)

Continuing Education

2026	Introduction to High-Performance Computing, Division of Information Technology, University of Maryland
2026	Summer Institute in Computational Social Science (SICSS-Stanford)
2024	Mercury Project Solutions Summit, Social Science Research Council

Last updated: September 28, 2026